



STUDY GUIDE

Project Mayhem (Improv) (DRAMA)

Category Overview

Project mayhem is an improvisational acting category that challenges delegates to think quickly, adapt creatively, and perform confidently under constantly evolving circumstances. Teams must construct and maintain a coherent story while responding to unexpected twists introduced throughout the performance. As the round progresses, delegates will face a series of challenges that test their versatility. From incorporating an iconic fictional character into an ongoing scene to seamlessly transforming the atmosphere through multiple genre shifts, participants must rely on teamwork, improvisation, and strong stage presence to keep the narrative engaging and believable. Before the round begins, each team will receive a situation from the Category Heads, which will serve as the foundation of their improvisation. Teams will also be instructed to reserve one delegate, who will remain off-stage when the performance begins. The round will undergo 3 phase changes, which will change the direction of the improv.

Phase 1 – Character Entrance

Approximately one minute into the performance, the Category Heads will announce a fictional character from a movie, television series, game, or other well-known media. The reserved delegate must enter the performance portraying that character while remaining faithful to their personality, mannerisms, and behavior. The existing performers must naturally incorporate the new arrival into their ongoing scene without disrupting the flow of the story.

Phase 2 – Genre Shift

After approximately one to two minutes, the Category Heads will announce a new genre. Without stopping the performance, the team must transition their ongoing scene into the announced genre while maintaining continuity. Dialogue, emotions, pacing, and character interactions should evolve naturally to reflect the new style without abandoning the original storyline.

Phase 3 – Final Shift

One to two minutes after the first transition, a second genre will be announced. Teams must once again adapt their performance, seamlessly transforming the story into the newly assigned genre while preserving the narrative established throughout the round. The conclusion should feel coherent, creative, and engaging despite the multiple changes introduced during the performance.



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Judging Criteria:

- Improvisation & Adaptability – 12 Marks

The team's ability to think quickly, react naturally to unexpected challenges, and maintain the flow of the performance.

- Character Portrayal & Integration – 10 Marks

How accurately the introduced character is portrayed and how seamlessly they are incorporated into the ongoing story.

- Genre Transition & Execution – 12 Marks

The effectiveness of adapting to both genre switches while convincingly portraying the characteristics of each genre.

- Story Continuity – 8 Marks

The ability to maintain a clear, logical, and engaging storyline throughout all three phases of the performance.

- Teamwork & Stage Presence – 8 Marks

The coordination between team members, confidence on stage, and overall quality of the performance.

Total: 50 Marks